

D382

Digital Marketing Analytics

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A city zoo runs search ads, posts updates on its own blog, and gets a TV news segment after a baby giraffe is born. The giraffe weighed 150 pounds at birth. Which classification of the three channels is correct?

- A. All three are owned, since they all send people to the zoo's site.
- B. News segment = paid, because staff time went into the pitch.
- C. Search ads = paid; blog = owned; news segment = earned.
- D. Blog = earned, because visitors chose to read it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A B2B software company's objective this year is to grow new annual contract revenue by 20%. The social team reports 50,000 new followers and 1 million impressions. The CEO spoke at three conferences. Which is the best KPI for marketing?

- A. Total impressions
- B. Number of conference talks given
- C. Revenue from new contracts that began as marketing-sourced leads
- D. New follower count

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A marketing team's KPI is "repeat purchase rate within 90 days." Which objective is it most likely tracking?

- A. Improve customer retention and loyalty
- B. Grow brand awareness
- C. Any objective, since every KPI measures all goals
- D. Acquire new customers

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A retailer's analyst notices that weeks with more Instagram posts also had higher sales. Those same weeks included holiday promotions. The analyst built the chart in a new dashboard tool. What should be concluded?

- A. The link is a correlation that holidays may explain; a controlled test is needed to show Instagram's effect.
- B. Posting drives sales, so the team should post more.
- C. The new dashboard tool confirms the cause.
- D. Correlation never has any value in marketing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which design best shows whether a display campaign actually causes extra sales?

- A. Surveying customers on whether they remember the ad
- B. A randomized holdout test that withholds ads from a control group and compares sales
- C. Counting last-click conversions from the ads
- D. Comparing sales the month before and the month after launch

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A customer sees a YouTube ad, later reads a blog review, then clicks a branded search ad and buys on a Tuesday. The company's report uses last-click attribution. What is the main risk?

- A. Tuesday purchases need a day-weighted model.
- B. It over-credits the YouTube ad.
- C. There is no risk; the last click always causes the sale.
- D. It gives all credit to branded search and undervalues YouTube and the blog, which could lead to cutting them.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A hotel chain wants data to personalize offers as third-party cookies fade. It has a loyalty program with 2 million members and just redesigned its lobbies. Which source is first-party data?

- A. None; privacy laws forbid using any customer data
- B. Loyalty members' booking histories and stated preferences
- C. Customer data shared by a partner airline
- D. Audience segments bought from a data broker

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A web analytics report lists four fields: session source, device category, sessions, and purchase revenue. The site recently moved to a new server. Which fields are dimensions?

- A. Sessions and purchase revenue
- B. All four fields
- C. Device category and sessions
- D. Session source and device category

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An analyst wants to see purchase revenue broken down by country. In this report, which field is the metric?

- A. Both, since both appear as report columns
- B. Neither; a custom event is required first
- C. Purchase revenue
- D. Country

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

An email campaign designed by an award-winning freelancer cost \$4,000 and produced \$10,000 in attributable revenue at a 50% gross margin. What was the marketing ROI based on gross profit?

- A.** 25%
- B.** 125%
- C.** 2.5:1
- D.** 150%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A campaign produced \$30,000 in gross profit and a 50% ROI. What did the campaign cost?

- A.** \$15,000
- B.** \$20,000
- C.** \$45,000
- D.** \$60,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A subscription app with 400,000 users in 30 countries builds a model that estimates each user's chance of canceling next month. Which type of analytics is this?

- A.** Diagnostic
- B.** Descriptive
- C.** Prescriptive
- D.** Predictive

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A city zoo runs search ads, posts updates on its own blog, and gets a TV news segment after a baby giraffe is born. ~~The giraffe weighed 150 pounds at birth.~~ Which classification of the three channels is correct?

Target word: classify channels **Decides:** Who pays and who controls each channel.

A	Absolute language	Where traffic lands does not define the channel type.
B	Adjacent category	Staff effort does not make coverage paid; no placement was bought.
C	Correct	Bought, controlled, and freely given, in that order.
D	Confusion set	The zoo controls its blog, so it is owned.

2. Answer C Concept 2

A B2B software company's objective this year is to grow new annual contract revenue by 20%. The social team reports 50,000 new followers and 1 million impressions. ~~The CEO spoke at three conferences.~~ Which is the best KPI for marketing?

Target word: KPI for the objective **Decides:** Objective is new contract revenue.

A	Confusion set	An exposure metric, not an outcome.
B	Camouflage	An activity count tied to the camouflage detail.
C	Correct	Directly measures marketing's contribution to the stated objective.
D	Adjacent category	A vanity metric that does not show revenue progress.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

A marketing team's KPI is "repeat purchase rate within 90 days." Which objective is it most likely tracking?

Target word: reverse: from KPI to objective **Decides:** Repeat purchases measure retention.

A	Correct	Repeat buying is a direct retention measure.
B	Adjacent category	Awareness is measured by reach and recall.
C	Absolute language	A KPI is chosen for one objective.
D	Inverted operation	Repeat purchases come from existing customers, not new ones.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A retailer's analyst notices that weeks with more Instagram posts also had higher sales. Those same weeks included holiday promotions. ~~The analyst built the chart in a new dashboard tool.~~ What should be concluded?

Target word: what the data shows **Decides:** Holidays are a likely confounder.

A	Correct	Co-movement is not proof of cause.
B	Dropped element	Drops the holiday confounder.
C	Camouflage	A tool does not turn correlation into causation.
D	Absolute language	Correlation can point to hypotheses worth testing.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

Which design best shows whether a display campaign actually causes extra sales?

Target word: reverse: from goal to method **Decides:** Need a comparison group that did not see the ads.

A	Confusion set	Measures recall, not sales caused.
B	Correct	Randomization isolates the ads' incremental effect.
C	Dropped element	Drops the sales that would have happened anyway.
D	Adjacent category	Seasonality and other changes are mixed in.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A customer sees a YouTube ad, later reads a blog review, then clicks a branded search ad and buys ~~on a Tuesday~~. The company's report uses last-click attribution. What is the main risk?

Target word: risk of last-click **Decides:** All credit goes to the final branded search.

A	Camouflage	The weekday does not decide attribution.
B	Inverted operation	Last-click gives YouTube zero credit.
C	Absolute language	Earlier touches often create the demand.
D	Correct	Last-click ignores earlier touchpoints.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A hotel chain wants data to personalize offers as third-party cookies fade. It has a loyalty program with 2 million members ~~and just redesigned its lobbies~~. Which source is first-party data?

Target word: first-party source **Decides:** Collected directly by the hotel from its own customers.

A	Absolute language	Consented first-party data can be used within the law.
B	Correct	Collected directly by the hotel from its own customers.
C	Adjacent category	Another firm's first-party data is second-party to the hotel.
D	Confusion set	Aggregated and purchased, so third-party.

8. Answer D Concept 6

A web analytics report lists four fields: session source, device category, sessions, and purchase revenue. ~~The site recently moved to a new server.~~ Which fields are dimensions?

Target word: which are dimensions **Decides:** Attributes vs. counted numbers.

A	Inverted operation	Those are metrics.
B	Dropped element	Drops the metric/dimension distinction.
C	Confusion set	Mixes one dimension with one metric.
D	Correct	Both describe attributes of sessions.

9. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

An analyst wants to see purchase revenue broken down by country. In this report, which field is the metric?

Target word: reverse: pick the metric **Decides:** Revenue is summed; country is an attribute.

A	Absolute language	Column position does not make a field a metric.
B	Adjacent category	Standard e-commerce fields already provide both.
C	Correct	A number that is summed across rows.
D	Inverted operation	Country is the dimension that splits the metric.

10. Answer A **Concept 7**

An email campaign ~~designed by an award-winning freelancer~~ cost \$4,000 and produced \$10,000 in attributable revenue at a 50% gross margin. What was the marketing ROI based on gross profit?

Target word: ROI on profit **Decides:** Profit \$5,000 minus cost \$4,000, over cost.

A	Correct	$(\$5,000 - \$4,000) / \$4,000 = 25\%$.
B	Dropped element	$\$5,000 / \$4,000$ forgets to subtract the cost.
C	Confusion set	Revenue / cost is ROAS, not ROI.
D	Adjacent category	Uses revenue instead of gross profit.

11. Answer B **Concept 7 • transfer**

A campaign produced \$30,000 in gross profit and a 50% ROI. What did the campaign cost?

Target word: solve for cost **Decides:** Profit = cost $\times$ (1 + ROI).

A	Inverted operation	Multiplies profit by 0.5.
B	Correct	$\$30,000 / 1.5 = \$20,000$; check: $\$10,000 / \$20,000 = 50\%$.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies profit by 1.5 instead of dividing.
D	Dropped element	$\$30,000 / 0.5$ drops the "1 +" in the formula.

12. Answer D **Concept 8**

A subscription app ~~with 400,000 users in 30 countries~~ builds a model that estimates each user's chance of canceling next month. Which type of analytics is this?

Target word: analytics type **Decides:** Estimating a future outcome.

A	Confusion set	Explains why something happened.
B	Confusion set	Describes what already happened.
C	Adjacent category	Recommends actions; the model only estimates risk.
D	Correct	Forecasts what is likely to happen.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Paid, owned, and earned channels	Paid channels are bought, owned channels are controlled by the brand, earned channels are coverage or sharing others give freely; each is measured differently.	Classifying by where the traffic lands instead of who controls and pays for the channel.	A mix of ads, brand-run channels, and third-party coverage.
2	KPIs tie to objectives	A KPI is the metric that directly shows progress on a business objective; other numbers are supporting or vanity metrics.	Reporting followers or impressions as the KPI for a revenue goal.	A stated business objective followed by a list of metrics.
3	Correlation vs. causation	Two metrics moving together do not prove one causes the other; controlled tests (holdouts, A/B) show causal lift.	Crediting a channel for sales that a confounding factor explains.	"Weeks with more X had more sales."
4	Attribution bias	Last-click attribution gives all credit to the final touch and undervalues upper-funnel channels.	Cutting awareness channels because last-click shows them earning nothing.	A multi-touch path reported under last-click.
5	First-, second-, and third-party data	First-party data is collected directly from your own customers; second-party is another firm's first-party data shared with you; third-party is bought from aggregators.	Calling partner or broker data first-party.	Who collected the data and from whom.
6	Dimensions vs. metrics	Dimensions describe attributes (source, device, country); metrics are numbers you count or sum (sessions, revenue).	Calling any report column a metric.	A list of report fields to sort into types.
7	Marketing ROI	$ROI = (\text{gross profit from the campaign} - \text{campaign cost}) / \text{campaign cost}$.	Using revenue instead of profit, or forgetting to subtract cost.	Revenue, margin, and cost together.
8	Types of analytics	Descriptive = what happened; diagnostic = why; predictive = what will likely happen; prescriptive = what to do.	Calling a forecast descriptive or a recommendation predictive.	The question the analysis answers.

Course scope (public description): Digital Marketing Analytics teaches learners how to identify data sources, collect and analyze data, and manage marketing performance. Marketing requires an understanding of analytics and application of data to inform strategic decision-making. Through the use of a digital marketing analytics framework, measurement models, and various digital marketing technology tools, learners will analyze marketing performance across digital paid, owned, and earned channels. The latest marketing technology tools are explored to measure and optimize results using data-driven decisions. In this course, learners will have the opportunity to complete the Google Analytics certification to gain technical skills used in practice and to enhance marketability within the marketing profession.